Cross-Curricular Centers

"The Mixed-Up Chameleon" by Eric Carle · Cut apart and place at stations around the house

SCIENCE CENTER

⏱ 30 min

Chameleon Habitat

Build a mini chameleon habitat in a shoe box! Use real leaves, twigs, and sand for the ground. Cut flowers and trees from construction paper. Then cut out a chameleon and place it in the habitat. Can your chameleon hide? Talk about why blending in helps chameleons stay safe from predators.

MATERIALS

Shoe box · real leaves + twigs · sand · construction paper · scissors · glue · crayons

🔗 **Story connection:** *The chameleon in the story wanted to look like other animals. Real chameleons change color to blend in with their surroundings!*

LITERACY CENTER

⏱ 15 min

Changing Words

Write consonants and blends (b, h, r, s, sl, gr, pr, sk) on separate cards. Write "-ide" on one card and "-id" on another. Put a consonant card in front of each ending to build words. How many real words can you make? Write your favorites in your journal!

MATERIALS

Index cards or paper squares · pencils · journal or notebook

🔗 **Story connection:** *The chameleon kept CHANGING — and these words change too when you swap the first letter!*

TECHNOLOGY CENTER

⏱ 15 min

Chameleon Composing

Open a word document or Google Doc. Write 2–3 sentences comparing the chameleon in the story to a real chameleon. How are they the same? How are they different? Use the spell-checker to find and fix any spelling mistakes before you print it!

MATERIALS

Computer or tablet · word processing app (Google Docs, Pages, Word)

🔗 **Story connection:** *The story chameleon wanted to be like other animals. A real chameleon can only change colors. What else is different?*

SOCIAL STUDIES CENTER

⏱ 30 min

Zoo Map

The chameleon visited a zoo and saw flamingos, elephants, polar bears, and deer. Draw a map of YOUR imaginary zoo! Include a flamingo pond, an elephant area, and any other animals you want. Put a letter and number grid on your map (like A1, B2) so someone could find each area.

MATERIALS

Large construction paper · crayons or markers · ruler (optional, for grid lines)

🔗 **Story connection:** *The chameleon saw all these amazing animals at the zoo. Your map shows where each one lives!*

🎭 **DRAMA CENTER** ⏱ 15 min

A Day in the Life of a Chameleon

Pretend to be a chameleon! Use a party blowout as your tongue — try to "catch" paper fly cutouts. Act out other chameleon behaviors: move slowly, look around with your eyes going different directions, "change colors" by holding up different colored paper. Can you act out the whole story?

📦 **MATERIALS**

Party blowouts (1 per child) · paper fly cutouts · colored paper squares

🔗 **Story connection:** *Now YOU are the mixed-up chameleon! Act out what happened in the story — the wishing, the changing, and the happy ending.*

🛒 **WEEK'S CENTER SUPPLIES** checklist

Everything You Need

✅ **You probably have**

- ☐ Construction paper
- ☐ Scissors + glue
- ☐ Crayons or markers
- ☐ Pencils
- ☐ Index cards / paper squares
- ☐ Notebook or journal
- ☐ Computer or tablet
- ☐ Ruler (optional)

🛍️ **You might need to grab**

- ☐ Shoe box (1 per child)
- ☐ Real leaves + twigs
- ☐ Sand (a small cup)
- ☐ Party blowouts
- ☐ Fly cutouts (or draw them!)

✂️ *Cut along the dashed lines to place cards at different stations around the house*